NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

REVISION HUB
SCAN TO LAUNCH

YEAR 9 ENQUIRY M-A-I-N CAUSES, IMPERIAL CRISES, NAVAL ARMS RACE & THE JULY CRISIS

CAUSES OF THE GREAT WAR (1871–1914)

Overarching Enquiry: "How did decades of imperial rivalry, dreadnoughts, and alliances culminate in thirty-seven days of madness?"



PRIMARY NAVAL PLATE • 1906 **IMPERIAL WAR MUSEUM • LONDON**

HMS Dreadnought at Sea (1906)

The revolutionary British battleship whose steam turbines and ten 12-inch heavy guns rendered all existing warships obsolete overnight, igniting the Anglo-German naval arms race.

THE 6 HISTORICAL ENQUIRIES ACROSS THIS UNIT • KNOWLEDGE CHECKLIST 1871–1914

ENQUIRY 1

To what extent was the creation of the German Empire in 1871 a comp...

- Prussian military victory & 1871 proclamation in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles
- Otto von Bismarck's Realpolitik, Krupp industrial steel & 'Iron and Blood' statecraft
- Disruption of the 1815 Congress of Vienna balance of power by a unified giant

ENQUIRY 2

How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into why the annexati...

- 1871 Treaty of Frankfurt: 5 billion franc war indemnity & loss of border fortresses
- French revanchism: classroom maps shaded in black (La Tache Noire) & youth rifle drills
- Bismarck's strategic glacis buffer vs German fear of a vengeful two-front encirclement

ENQUIRY 3

Which interpretation better explains why European powers clashed ov...

- Kaiser Wilhelm II dismisses Bismarck (1890) and demands Germany's "Place in the Sun"
- First Moroccan Crisis (1905): Kaiser lands at Tangier to test the new Anglo-French Entente
- Second Moroccan Crisis (1911): SMS Panther gunboat at Agadir and Lloyd George's warning

ENQUIRY 4

Was the naval arms race the primary reason Britain ended its "Splen...

- 1906 launch of HMS Dreadnought in Portsmouth: turbine speed & ten 12-inch heavy guns
- Admiral von Tirpitz's German Navy Laws & 'Risk Theory' challenging British North Sea control
- British Two-Power Standard, island food import vulnerability & the "We want eight!" campaign

ENQUIRY 5

Did the European alliance system preserve peace between the Great P...

- Triple Alliance (1882) vs Dual Alliance (1894) & Triple Entente (1907)
- Secret military protocols, automatic mutual defence triggers & rigid timetables
- Willy-Nicky telegrams: royal cousins powerless to halt military mobilisation

ENQUIRY 6

Could the First World War have been avoided after the shots in Sara...

- 28 June 1914: Princip and the Black Hand assassinate Franz Ferdinand in Sarajevo
- The July Crisis: Germany's "Blank Cheque", Austrian ultimatum & Russian mobilisation
- Schlieffen Plan: German invasion of neutral Belgium brings Britain into the war

HOW TO WRITE LIKE A HISTORIAN 4 GOLDEN RULES & CONNECTIVES

THE 4 GOLDEN RULES OF EXTENDED WRITING:

1. Direct Thesis: Clear answer in sentence 1.

2. Specific Evidence: Names, dates, acts & data.

3. Causal Mechanics: Explain *why* & *how*.

4. Evaluative Balance: Weighted judgement.

HIGH-IMPACT ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

Causation: *Consequently • Precipitated by • Directly resulted in*

Nuance & Evaluation: *Conversely • While ostensibly... in reality • Decisively*

THE 4 BIG STORYLINES TO TRACK CORE HISTORICAL THEMES

1. Imperial Alliances & State Control: Balance of power collapse → DORA censorship & munitions acts → Imperial fall

2. Industrialised Warfare: Artillery barrages → Trench networks & machine guns → Tanks & aerial combat

3. Militarism, Propaganda & Mindset: Jingoistic recruitment → Attrition psychology → Shell shock & disillusionment

4. Dissent, Conscience & Revolution: Conscientious objectors → Munitions strikes → Naval mutinies & 1918 Armistice

LIVING UNIT TIMELINE • PART 1: THE RISE OF RIVALRIES (1871–1904)

PAGES 2–3 FACING SPREAD

How to use this timeline: Record your key notes, evidence, and causal links for each milestone as you progress through the unit. Spine • Facing Left

1871 • The German Empire Proclaimed at Versailles

LESSON 1

Following Prussia's swift victory in the Franco-Prussian War, King Wilhelm I is proclaimed German Emperor in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles. Otto von Bismarck unites 39 separate states into a powerful new industrial empire, permanently upsetting the traditional European balance of power.

1871–1890 • Bismarckian Diplomacy & The French "Black Stain"

LESSON 2

Germany annexes the wealthy French provinces of Alsace and Lorraine. Humiliated by defeat and the loss of their lands, French politicians and classrooms embrace "revanche" (revenge). Bismarck works tirelessly to keep France diplomatically isolated through alliances with Russia and Austria.

1890–1904 • Wilhelm II, Weltpolitik & The Entente Cordiale

LESSON 3

Ambitious young Kaiser Wilhelm II dismisses Bismarck in 1890 and demands a "place in the sun" for Germany. German meddling in African colonies and blustering diplomacy alarms Britain, prompting London to abandon "Splendid Isolation" and sign the 1904 Entente Cordiale with France.

Timeline Check: How did Bismarck's unity in 1871 and the loss of Alsace-Lorraine begin Europe's division into rival camps?

Turn overleaf for Lesson 1 →

"Remember: A timeline without causal links is just a list of dates."

LIVING UNIT TIMELINE • PART 2: CRISES & THE ROAD TO WAR (1906–1914)

PAGES 2–3 FACING SPREAD

How to use this timeline: Record your key notes, evidence, and causal links for each milestone as you progress through the unit. Spine • Facing Right

1906–1912 • Launch of HMS Dreadnought & The Naval Race

LESSON 4

The Royal Navy launches HMS Dreadnought in Portsmouth, rendering all older battleships obsolete overnight with its ten 12-inch guns and steam turbines. When Germany starts building its own dreadnoughts, a feverish arms race erupts, convincing Britain that Germany poses a mortal threat.

1908–1914 • The Alliance System: Europe Divided into Armed Camps

LESSON 5

Europe hardens into two heavily armed rival blocs: the Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and the Triple Entente (Britain, France, Russia). Massive armies draw up strict railway mobilization plans, meaning any local border clash risks pulling all six great powers into war.

28 June – 4 Aug 1914 • The Sarajevo Spark & The Outbreak of Total War

LESSON 6

Gavrilo Princip assassinates Archduke Franz Ferdinand in Sarajevo. Germany issues Austria the "Blank Cheque" to crush Serbia. Russia mobilizes to protect fellow Slavs; Germany invades neutral Belgium; and on 4 August 1914, Britain enters the conflict. The Great War begins.

Timeline Check: Why did the naval arms race and the alliance tripwire turn an assassination in Bosnia into a global war? Use for revision →

EVIDENCE & SOURCE SKILLS

L1: How was the German Empire created in 1871?

WHAT WE ARE LEARNING TODAY:

- Learn how Prussia grew stronger through industry, railways, and army reforms.
- Explore how Chancellor Otto von Bismarck used three wars to bring German states together.
- Understand how the new German Empire in 1871 shattered the old balance of power.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE (5 PRIOR RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 5]

Q1: What was the "Balance of Power" in 19th-century Europe?	**Q2:** Name two major European empires that existed in 1870.	**Q3:** Why did Britain prefer that no single country dominated Europe?	**Q4:** How did railways and telegraphs change warfare by 1870?	**Q5:** What was the Zollverein, and which state led it?

TASK 2: KEY VOCABULARY

Core Definitions

Explain the difference between **Realpolitik** (practical politics based on power) and **Liberalism** (rule of law and elected parliaments):

TASK 3: EVIDENCE PREPARATION — BISMARCK'S STATECRAFT & THE 1871 GEOPOLITICAL RUPTURE

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

SOURCE A: BISMARCK SPEAKS TO THE PRUSSIAN PARLIAMENT (SEPTEMBER 1862)

PRUSSIAN STATE ARCHIVES • BERLIN

"Prussia's borders according to the Vienna treaties are not favorable to a healthy state life. Not by speeches and majority decisions will the great questions of the day be decided—that was the great mistake of 1848 and 1849—but by iron and blood."

Provenance: Minister-President Otto von Bismarck addressing the Budget Committee in Berlin, 1862.

READING CLUES:

① **Underline:** words showing Bismarck rejected parliamentary democracy.

② **Circle:** the phrase describing the old 1815 Vienna borders.

③ **Box:** the two words Bismarck said would decide the future.

Question 1: What does Source A reveal about why Bismarck chose military force over democracy to unify Germany?

Question 2: How did the sudden emergence of a unified, industrialized Germany in 1871 overturn the European balance of power?

Helpful Clue: Before 1871, Central Europe was fragmented and weak. Suddenly, 41 million people and Krupp steel formed a dominant military giant.

Challenge Question: Did 1871 represent a total break with the past, or was Bismarck continuing long-standing Prussian militarism?

EXTENDED WRITING

Task 4: Extended Enquiry • To what extent was the creation of the German Empire in 1871 a complete turning point in European peace?

PLANNING YOUR ANSWER: 3 KEY ARGUMENTS DRAFT QUICK BULLET POINTS BELOW ↓

1. PRE-1871 BALANCE	2. THE 1871 RUPTURE	3. YOUR CONCLUSION
Fragmented German states, Vienna settlement, and British/French continental security.	Blood and iron, Krupp artillery, seizing Alsace-Lorraine, and the 41m industrial powerhouse.	Judge whether 1871 was a total turning point or if monarchical rule and diplomacy continued.

Key Words: Realpolitik • Blood and Iron • Balance of Power • Otto von Bismarck • Franco-Prussian War • Hall of Mirrors • Turning point

Sentence Starters: *Before 1871, European peace rested on... • However, the creation of the German Empire was a turning point because... • On the other hand, certain continuities remained, such as... • In conclusion, 1871 was...*

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering the question. **[E] Evidence:** Names, dates, battles, and treaties. **[E] Explain:** How and why this caused tension. **[L] Link:** Direct conclusion answering enquiry.

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 1: 1871). On the timeline, record your notes or draw Bismarck's Prussian helmet and note the proclamation at

UNIT 9: CAUSES OF THE GREAT WAR • LESSON 2

L2: How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

EVIDENCE & SOURCE SKILLS

WHAT WE ARE LEARNING TODAY:

- Understand how the Siege of Paris and the harsh 1871 Treaty of Frankfurt shocked France.
- Explore how the loss of Alsace-Lorraine fuelled a deep desire for revenge (revanche).
- Explain how French schools and culture prepared a whole generation for future conflict.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE (5 PRIOR RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 5]

Q1: Which Prussian minister was famous for his "Blood and Iron" speech?	**Q2:** In which grand French palace was the German Empire proclaimed in 1871?	**Q3:** Which two provinces did Germany take from France after the war?	**Q4:** What is the French word for "revenge" (revanche)?	**Q5:** Why was France left feeling humiliated and isolated after 1871?

TASK 2: KEY VOCABULARY

Core Definitions

Complete the sentence using the terms **Revanche** (revenge) and **Annexation** (taking land by force):
After the German [ ] of Alsace-Lorraine, the French public demanded [ ] to reclaim their lost provinces.

TASK 3: FORENSIC SOURCE INTERROGATION — FRENCH GRIEF VS GERMAN MILITARY RATIONALE

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

SOURCE A: ALBERT BETTANNIER, "LA TACHE NOIRE" (1887)



"In French schoolrooms after 1871, maps showed Alsace-Lorraine shaded black in mourning. Boys were drilled in gymnastics and rifle handling, taught that their sacred duty was to win back the lost provinces."

Record: FRENCH MINISTRY OF EDUCATION • 1882 ARCHIVE

SOURCE B: OTTO VON BISMARCK ON THE ANNEXATION (1871)

"We take Alsace and northern Lorraine not to add territory, but as a defensive glacis and shield against France. For centuries, French armies have invaded Germany through Metz. By holding these fortresses, we secure our borders against future attack."

Record: PRUSSIAN STATE ARCHIVE • BERLIN DISPATCH

READING CLUES:

① **Underline:** in Source A, what the schoolmaster is pointing to on the classroom map.

② **Circle:** in Source B, the phrase Bismarck uses to justify taking the provinces ("defensive glacis and shield").

③ **Box:** in Source B, why Prussian generals insisted on holding the border fortresses.

Question 1: What does Source A reveal about how French schoolboys were educated to view Germany after 1871?

Question 2: How does Source B explain Germany's military justification for seizing the border provinces?

EXTENDED WRITING

Task 4: Extended Enquiry • How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into why the annexation of Alsace-Lorraine made lasting peace impossible?

PLANNING YOUR ANSWER: 3 KEY ARGUMENTS — DRAFT QUICK BULLET POINTS BELOW ↓

1. SOURCE A UTILITY	2. SOURCE B UTILITY	3. EVALUATIVE VERDICT
What Source A shows (revanche, mourning maps, military drills), who created it, and its value/limits.	What Source B reveals (Bismarck's defensive buffer, fear of French invasion), and its value/limits.	Conclude: how useful are both sources together in explaining why lasting peace became impossible?

Key Words: Revanche • Alsace-Lorraine • Treaty of Frankfurt • Siege of Paris • indemnity • Albert Bettannier • buffer zone • utility

Sentence Starters: *Source A is useful for investigating French attitudes because... • However, its value is limited because it represents... • In contrast, Source B is valuable for understanding German strategy because... • Together, both sources prove...*

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering the question.

[E] Evidence: Names, dates, battles, and treaties.

[E] Explain: How and why this caused tension.

[L] Link: Direct conclusion answering enquiry.

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 2: 1871). On the timeline, record your notes or sketch the map of France with the lost provinces of Alsace and

L3: How did imperialism and the "Scramble for Africa" fuel European rivalry?

EVIDENCE & SOURCE SKILLS

WHAT WE ARE LEARNING TODAY:

- Learn why European powers rushed to colonize 90% of Africa in just thirty years.
- Understand Kaiser Wilhelm II's ambition for Germany to have a "place in the sun".
- Analyze how colonial disputes in Morocco pushed Britain and France together against Germany.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE (5 PRIOR RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 5]

Q1: Which new Kaiser dismissed Bismarck in 1890?	**Q2:** What German phrase described Kaiser Wilhelm's aggressive world policy (Weltpolitik)?	**Q3:** What nickname was given to European powers carving up Africa between 1881 and 1914?	**Q4:** Which two European powers had by far the largest global empires in 1900?	**Q5:** What valuable raw materials did European nations want from African colonies?

TASK 2: KEY VOCABULARY

Core Definitions

Explain the difference between **Imperialism** (building an overseas empire) and **Weltpolitik** (Germany's aggressive drive for world influence):

TASK 3: HISTORIOGRAPHICAL ANALYSIS — VIEW A (ECONOMIC GREED) VS VIEW B (NATIONAL STATUS)

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

INTERPRETATION 1: VIEW A (ECONOMIC GREED & RESOURCE CLASHES)

"European powers carved up Africa primarily out of economic greed. As factories expanded in Britain, France, and Germany, industrialists desperately needed raw materials—rubber, copper, cotton, and palm oil—that Europe could not produce. Clashes like the Moroccan crises occurred because capitalist rivals fought to monopolize overseas markets and mineral wealth."

Provenance: Economic interpretation focusing on industrial resource hunger and trade competition.

INTERPRETATION 2: VIEW B (NATIONAL STATUS, PRIDE & DIPLOMACY)

"The scramble for Africa was driven by prestige and Great Power diplomacy rather than financial profit. Most colonies cost far more to govern than they ever made in trade. For Kaiser Wilhelm II, demanding a 'place in the sun' was about national pride—proving that Germany was a world superpower. Clashes in Africa were diplomatic tests of European alliances."

Provenance: Diplomatic interpretation focusing on imperial prestige, national pride, and testing alliances.

READING CLUES:

① **Underline:** in View A, the raw materials European factories desperately needed.

② **Circle:** in View B, what Kaiser Wilhelm II demanded for Germany ("place in the sun").

③ **Box:** in View B, why colonies often lost money rather than returning a profit.

Question 1: Using View A, explain why economic competition for raw materials made European rivals clash:

Question 2: Using View B, explain why national prestige and testing alliances were more important than profit:

EXTENDED WRITING

Task 4: Extended Enquiry • Which interpretation better explains why European powers clashed over Africa between 1884 and 1911?

PLANNING YOUR ANSWER: 3 KEY ARGUMENTS — DRAFT QUICK BULLET POINTS BELOW ↓

1. VIEW A: ECONOMIC GREED	2. VIEW B: NATIONAL STATUS	3. EVALUATIVE VERDICT
Raw materials (rubber, copper, oil), industrial factory needs, and commercial trade rivalry.	Wilhelm II demanding a "place in the sun", national pride, and testing the Entente in Morocco.	Which interpretation provides a more convincing explanation of imperial tension and why?

Key Words: Imperialism • Scramble for Africa • Weltpolitik • "Place in the Sun" • raw materials • national prestige • Moroccan Crises • interpretation

Sentence Starters: *View A argues that imperial clashes were driven by economic competition because... • In contrast, View B emphasizes national pride, arguing that... • Evidence supporting View B includes... • In conclusion, I find View [A/B] more convincing because...*

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering the question.	**[E] Evidence:** Names, dates, battles, and treaties.	**[E] Explain:** How and why this caused tension.	**[L] Link:** Direct conclusion answering enquiry.

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 3: 1898–1904). On the timeline, record your notes or sketch the African continent with British and French colonial

UNIT 9: CAUSES OF THE GREAT WAR • LESSON 4

L4: How did the launch of HMS Dreadnought trigger a naval arms race?

EVIDENCE & SOURCE SKILLS

WHAT WE ARE LEARNING TODAY:

- Understand how revolutionary engineering made HMS Dreadnought faster and more deadly.
- Explain why building dreadnoughts made all previous battleships obsolete overnight.
- Evaluate why Germany's decision to build battleships frightened Britain into a naval arms race.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE (5 PRIOR RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 5]

Q1: What British policy said the Royal Navy must equal the next two biggest navies combined?	**Q2:** In what year was the revolutionary battleship HMS Dreadnought launched in Portsmouth?	**Q3:** What new engine made Dreadnought faster than any previous battleship?	**Q4:** Which German admiral drew up the German Navy Laws to rival Britain?	**Q5:** What popular slogan did British newspapers print demanding eight new dreadnoughts?

TASK 2: KEY VOCABULARY

Core Definitions

Explain the difference between the British **Two-Power Standard** (naval safety policy) and the German **Risk Theory** (building enough ships to frighten Britain):

TASK 3: EVIDENCE PREPARATION — THE BATTLESHIP REVOLUTION & NAVAL CONSTRUCTION (1906)

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

SOURCE A: ADMIRAL SIR JOHN FISHER EXPLAINS THE DREADNOUGHT REVOLUTION (1906)

BRITISH ADMIRALTY RECORDS • PORTSMOUTH DOCKYARD

"HMS Dreadnought can sink the whole German fleet by herself before they can get close enough to hit her. She carries ten 12-inch guns and steam turbines driving her at 21 knots. It has made every existing battleship in the world obsolete."

Feature	Old Battleships (Pre-Dreadnought)	HMS Dreadnought (1906)
Main Armament	4 × 12-inch heavy guns + mixed smaller guns	**10 × 12-inch big guns (all-big-gun ship)**
Engines & Speed	Piston steam engines (18 knots maximum)	**Steam turbines (21 knots top speed)**
Effective Range	Accurate only up to 4 miles	**Accurate up to 8 miles with central fire control**

Question 1: Using the table, explain why HMS Dreadnought gave Germany a chance to challenge British naval supremacy:

Question 2: Why did Britain view Germany's battle fleet construction as a deadly threat to its national survival?

Helpful Clue: Britain is an island reliant on imported food; a hostile fleet in the North Sea could starve Britain within weeks, whereas Germany was a land power.

Challenge Question: Did Tirpitz's Risk Theory work, or did it make Germany's nightmare of British hostility come true?

EXTENDED WRITING

Task 4: Extended Enquiry • Was the naval arms race the primary reason Britain ended its "Splendid Isolation" to ally with France and Russia?

PLANNING YOUR ANSWER: 3 KEY ARGUMENTS DRAFT QUICK BULLET POINTS BELOW ↓

1. THE NAVAL THREAT	2. OTHER PRESSURES	3. CAUSAL HIERARCHY
Dreadnought, Tirpitz's Risk Fleet, British food imports, and invasion panic ("We want eight!").	German industrial export boom, Berlin-to-Baghdad railway, and bullying tactics in Morocco.	Judge whether the naval race was the primary cause of Britain allying with France/Russia, or a secondary factor.

Key Words: HMS Dreadnought • Two-Power Standard • Admiral Fisher • Admiral Tirpitz • Risk Theory • Splendid Isolation • Entente Cordiale • naval arms race

Sentence Starters: *The most critical factor pushing Britain away from isolation was... • For example, the naval challenge... • However, other factors also alarmed Britain, including... • In conclusion, I judge that the naval race was [primary / secondary] because...*

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering the question.	**[E] Evidence:** Names, dates, battles, and treaties.	**[E] Explain:** How and why this caused tension.	**[L] Link:** Direct conclusion answering enquiry.

EVIDENCE & SOURCE SKILLS

L5: How did rival alliances and secret treaties divide Europe into two armed camps?

WHAT WE ARE LEARNING TODAY:

- Identify the two armed camps: the Triple Alliance vs the Triple Entente.
- Understand how secret promises and mobilization timetables created a dangerous chain reaction.
- Investigate the private telegrams between Kaiser Wilhelm II and Tsar Nicholas II as war loomed.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE (5 PRIOR RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 5]

Q1: Which three nations formed the Triple Alliance in 1882?	**Q2:** Which three nations formed the Triple Entente by 1907?	**Q3:** What term describes an alliance where an attack on one is an attack on all?	**Q4:** What informal diplomatic friendly agreement did Britain and France sign in 1904?	**Q5:** Who were the royal cousins who sent the famous "Willy-Nicky" telegrams in July 1914?

TASK 2: KEY VOCABULARY

Core Definitions

Explain the difference between a **Defensive Alliance** (promising mutual help if attacked) and **Military Mobilization** (calling up millions of soldiers ready for war):

TASK 3: ARCHIVAL INTERROGATION — THE "WILLY-NICKY" TELEGRAMS & ALLIANCE CLAUSES

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

TELEGRAM 1: TSAR NICHOLAS II TO KAISER WILHELM II (29 JULY 1914)

"To try and avoid such a calamity as a European war, I beg you in the name of our old friendship to do what you can to stop your ally [Austria] from going too far. An ignominious war has been declared on a weak country [Serbia]. — NICKY"

RUSSIAN IMPERIAL TELEGRAPH ARCHIVE • ST PETERSBURG

TELEGRAM 2: KAISER WILHELM II TO TSAR NICHOLAS II (30 JULY 1914)

"The whole weight of the decision lies upon your shoulders now, who have to bear the responsibility for Peace or War. My ally is acting justly against a nest of assassins. If Russia mobilizes, I will be forced to mobilize too. — WILLY"

GERMAN IMPERIAL TELEGRAPH ARCHIVE • BERLIN

READING CLUES:

① **Underline:** the word the Tsar uses to describe European war ("calamity").

② **Circle:** how the Kaiser describes Serbia ("nest of assassins").

③ **Box:** the warnings both leaders give about military mobilization.

Question 1: What do these telegrams show about the personal relationship between the Tsar and the Kaiser?

Question 2: Why were the two leaders unable to stop the war despite calling each other by childhood nicknames?

Helpful Clue: Behind their personal friendship, both leaders were trapped by rigid army railway plans and alliance promises.

Challenge Question: Did alliances cause the war, or did the fear of being left without allies cause the war?

EXTENDED WRITING

Task 4: Extended Enquiry • Did the European alliance system preserve peace between the Great Powers, or make a general war inevitable?

PLANNING YOUR ANSWER: 3 KEY ARGUMENTS — DRAFT QUICK BULLET POINTS BELOW ↓

1. THE PEACEKEEPER CASE	2. THE INEVITABLE TRIPWIRE	3. EVALUATIVE VERDICT
Deterrence, balance of power for over twenty years, and leaders using diplomacy during crises.	Secret agreements, military staff talks, and the domino effect of rigid railway mobilization plans.	Did alliances successfully keep peace for decades, or did they make a general world war unavoidable?

Key Words: Triple Alliance • Triple Entente • Willy-Nicky telegrams • Entente Cordiale • mobilization • tripwire • balance of power • deterrence

Sentence Starters: *Defenders of the alliance system argue that it kept the peace because... • However, critics argue it acted as an inevitable tripwire because... • The Willy-Nicky telegrams prove that... • Therefore, I conclude that...*

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering the question.	**[E] Evidence:** Names, dates, battles, and treaties.	**[E] Explain:** How and why this caused tension.	**[L] Link:** Direct conclusion answering enquiry.

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5: 1908–1914). On the timeline, record your notes or draw the two opposing alliance flags connected by chains.

EVIDENCE & SOURCE SKILLS

L6: How did an assassination in Sarajevo trigger the outbreak of the First World War?

WHAT WE ARE LEARNING TODAY:

- Follow the dramatic events of 28 June 1914 in Sarajevo, including the fateful wrong turn.
- Understand how the German "Blank Cheque" gave Austria-Hungary the confidence to attack Serbia.
- Trace the 37-day countdown of the July Crisis from assassination to a world war.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE (5 PRIOR RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 5]

Q1: In which Bosnian city was Archduke Franz Ferdinand assassinated on 28 June 1914?	**Q2:** Name the 19-year-old Bosnian Serb student who fired the fatal shots.	**Q3:** What secret nationalist Serbian society helped train and arm the assassins?	**Q4:** What promise did Germany give to Austria on 5 July 1914, backing them unconditionally?	**Q5:** Which neutral country did Germany invade, forcing Britain to enter the war on 4 August?

TASK 2: KEY VOCABULARY

Core Definitions

Explain the difference between the **Sarajevo Spark** (the immediate trigger) and the **Blank Cheque** (Germany's promise of unconditional military backing):

TASK 3: DUAL EVIDENCE — EYEWITNESS IN SARAJEVO & THE GERMAN BLANK CHEQUE

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

SOURCE A: EYEWITNESS ACCOUNT OF COUNT FRANZ VON HARRACH (28 JUNE 1914)

"As the car reversed slowly to correct the driver's wrong turn outside Schiller's shop, a youth stepped from the crowd. He aimed a Browning pistol point-blank into the carriage and fired twice. A thin stream of blood spurted from the Archduke's mouth upon my cheek. Duchess Sophie cried out: 'For heaven's sake! What has happened to you?' Then she sank lifeless across his knees."

Provenance: Count Harrach was an Austrian officer standing on the running board of the royal car protecting the Archduke.

SOURCE B: KAISER WILHELM II'S "BLANK CHEQUE" DISPATCH (5 JULY 1914)

"Emperor Franz Joseph may rest assured that His Majesty the Kaiser will stand loyally by Austria-Hungary, in accordance with the alliance, even if matters should result in war between Austria-Hungary and Russia. Austria-Hungary should judge what is to be done; Germany stands steadfastly beside her."

Provenance: Official diplomatic telegram guaranteeing unconditional German military backing for Austria's war against Serbia.

READING CLUES:

① **Underline:** what the royal car was doing when the assassin fired (Source A).

② **Circle:** the German promise to stand loyally by Austria even if Russia intervenes (Source B).

③ **Box:** the physical detail showing the Archduke was mortally wounded (Source A).

Question 1: Using Source A, describe how the driver's wrong turn outside Schiller's shop gave the assassin his chance:

Question 2: Using Source B, explain why Germany's "Blank Cheque" gave Austria-Hungary the confidence to declare war on Serbia:

Helpful Clue: Austria was terrified that Russia would defend Serbia. The Kaiser's promise gave Austria the green light to strike.

Challenge Question: Without Germany's Blank Cheque, would the Sarajevo assassination have stayed a localized Balkan conflict?

"One fatal wrong turn in Sarajevo pulled twenty nations into war in thirty-seven days."

EXTENDED WRITING

Task 4: Extended Enquiry • Could the First World War have been avoided after the shots in Sarajevo, or had decades of M-A-I-N tension made conflict inevitable?

PLANNING YOUR ANSWER: 3 KEY ARGUMENTS — DRAFT QUICK BULLET POINTS BELOW ↓

1. THE SARAJEVO SPARK	2. THE JULY CRISIS & M-A-I-N	3. SYNOPTIC VERDICT
Princip, the Black Hand, the failed bomb, and the stalled car outside Schiller's Delicatessen.	The Blank Cheque (5 July), Austria's harsh ultimatum to Serbia, and Russia mobilizing to protect Slavs.	Judge whether the spark in Sarajevo created the war, or if decades of M-A-I-N tension made an explosion inevitable.

Key Words: Sarajevo • Gavrilo Princip • Black Hand • Franz Ferdinand • Blank Cheque • Ultimatum • Schlieffen Plan • Belgium • 4 August 1914

Sentence Starters: *The immediate trigger occurred when... • However, this localized crisis escalated because... • Without the Blank Cheque... • Ultimately...*

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering the question.	**[E] Evidence:** Names, dates, battles, and treaties.	**[E] Explain:** How and why this caused tension.	**[L] Link:** Direct conclusion answering enquiry.

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6: 1914). On the timeline, record your notes or sketch Gavrilo Princip's Browning pistol and the royal car.

PUPIL: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TARGET LEVEL:** [ ] **TARGET GCSE:** [ ]

KS3 PATHWAY	**Emerging (1–2):** Recalls isolated facts; basic descriptive narrative.	**Emerging+ (3):** Identifies causes & features with basic explanation.	**Expected (4–5):** Structured PEEL writing; supports with specific evidence.	**Expected+ (6–7):** Detailed causation; balances competing factors.	**Greater Depth (8–9):** Nuanced historical judgements; evaluates provenance & interpretations.
EFFORT RUBRIC	**1 • Concern:** Disengaged or incomplete work.	**2 • Inconsistent:** Needs repeated teacher prompts.	**3 • Satisfactory:** Meets baseline expectations.	**4 • Good:** Proactive focus & thoughtful work.	**5 • Exemplary:** Exceptional scholarship & pride.

#	LESSON ENQUIRY TITLE	Effort (1–5)	Attainment Level	TEACHER FORMATIVE FEEDBACK & NEXT STEPS
L1	How was the German Empire created in 1871?			
L2	How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?			
L3	How did imperialism and the "Scramble for Africa" fuel European rivalry?			
L4	How did the launch of HMS Dreadnought trigger a naval arms race?			
L5	How did rival alliances and secret treaties divide Europe into two armed camps?			
L6	How did an assassination in Sarajevo trigger the outbreak of the First World War?			
UNIT SUMMATIVE OUTCOME • TARGET STANDARD MET?				**Teacher Sign:** _____ • **Date:** ___/___/2026

OVERALL UNIT FORMATIVE FEEDBACK & ACADEMIC GUIDANCE KEY STAGE 3 MASTERY

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

DIGITAL REVISION & INTERACTIVE QUIZZING HUB • 6 LESSON QR CODES (60 TOTAL QUESTIONS) Scan with Mobile / Tablet

LESSON 1	LESSON 2	LESSON 3	LESSON 4	LESSON 5	LESSON 6
German Empire	Alsace-Lorraine	Scramble for Africa	Naval Arms Race	Alliance System	Sarajevo Spark
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]

🎯 **YEAR 9 REVISION PROTOCOL • 4 EVIDENCE-BASED RETRIEVAL TECHNIQUES** COGNITIVE SCIENCE IN PRACTICE

1. Spaced Quizzing
Scan each QR code weekly. Retest until scoring 10/10 before reviewing your notes.

2. Dual-Coding Walk
Turn to Pages 2–3. Cover the text and narrate 1871–1914 using your sketchpad symbols.

3. 5-Min Brain Dumps
Pick one enquiry. Write every date, treaty, and battle from memory in 5 minutes.

4. Causal Connectives
Draft PEEL sentences explaining causation: *Consequently... This directly resulted in...*